

Lecture 0

Intro

Carlo Prato

POLS W4732

This class

Game theory for social scientists

Designed as the second class in the PoliSci PhD sequence

Blending tools and methods with applications

Learning objectives

Familiarity with foundational concepts in Game Theory
Becoming a good consumer of formal political theory
Start incorporating formal reasoning into your research

Class Structure

2 weekly lectures

Lecture slides constitute the main material

Slides often based on papers

Problem Sets (graded) and applications (TA sessions)

Verification Tasks (10 mins quizzes)

Preliminary Outline:

- Formalism/Refresher on static games
- Repeated Games
- Bargaining
- Imperfect information (hidden action)
- Incomplete information (hidden information)
- Signaling
- Agency
- Career Concerns
- Cheap Talk
- Electoral Competition
- Autocratic Politics

Grading

7 Problem Sets worth 5% (except PS1 which is 4%) of final grade

- you are encouraged to discuss answers with each other
- you can submit in groups
- you **MUST** type answers

verification tasks (in class quiz), each 2%

Midterm (Oct 22), 21%

Final (TBD), 21%

No Electronics Policy

- ciao

Logistics

TR 2:40–3:55PM

Office Hour: Tuesday, 10:00–12:00, (Zoom optional)

Sign up online: <https://goo.gl/WhS3MR>

Email cp2928 [at] columbia.edu

Teaching Assistant

Seung Shin

Email ss5370 [at] columbia.edu

Office Hour: [TBD]

TA Section: [TBD]

About Carlo

(North)West-Italy born and raised

Econ PhD from Northwestern

At times, a bit more assertive than intended

Learned English at 19 $\Rightarrow$ has an accent

- **SPEAK UP** if what I say is unclear!

About Seung

[EDIT]

Your feedback is really valued

Clarity of instruction and material

Pace of instruction (too fast/too slow)

Integration between lectures and sections

Sequence of topics

About you

Briefly introduce yourself to the class

Veteran of POLS4730?

Research interests?